

BEFORE DAY 1 · QUICK REFERENCE

Laptop Compatibility Check

Run the command in the matching column for your OS. No installs, no changes — every command below only reads information. Compare your result to the last column.

Open a terminal first — Windows: search “PowerShell” in the Start menu. Linux: press Ctrl+Alt+T.

Minimum spec, at a glance: 8 GB RAM · dual-core 64-bit CPU · 20 GB free disk · Windows 10 (64-bit, build 19041+) / Windows 11, or a 64-bit Linux distro (Ubuntu 22.04+, Debian 11+, Fedora 37+ etc).

THE CHECKS — RUN EACH ROW

Check	Windows (PowerShell)	Linux (Terminal)	You want to see
RAM (total)	<code>(Get-CimInstance Win32_ComputerSystem).TotalPhysicalMemory</code>	<code>free -h</code>	8 GB or more
CPU cores	<code>(Get-CimInstance Win32_ComputerSystem).NumberOfLogicalProcessors</code>	<code>nproc</code>	2 or more cores
64-bit architecture	<code>[Environment]::Is64BitOperatingSystem</code>	<code>uname -m</code>	True / x86_64 (or aarch64)
Free disk space	<code>Get-PSDrive C Select-Object Used,Free</code>	<code>df -h ~</code>	20 GB or more free
OS version	<code>winver</code> (opens a small info window)	<code>cat /etc/os-release</code>	Win 10 build 19041+ / Win 11 or any current 64-bit distro
Virtualization support (needed for WSL2 / Docker)	Open Task Manager > Performance > CPU > check “Virtualization”	<code>egrep -c '(vmx svm)' /proc/cpuinfo</code>	“Enabled” / a number 1 or higher
Internet connection	<code>ping github.com</code>	<code>ping github.com</code>	Replies received, no timeouts

ONCE TOOLS ARE INSTALLED — CONFIRM EACH ONE

Tool	Windows (PowerShell)	Linux (Terminal)	You want to see
Git	<code>git --version</code>	<code>git --version</code>	A version number, e.g. git version 2.44
Python	<code>python --version</code>	<code>python3 --version</code>	Python 3.10 or newer
VS Code	<code>code --version</code>	<code>code --version</code>	A version number

Tool	Windows (PowerShell)	Linux (Terminal)	You want to see
WSL2 (Windows only)	<code>wsl --version</code>	—	A version number, no error
Docker (Module 7+)	<code>docker --version</code>	<code>docker --version</code>	A version number

If a check fails: if virtualization shows “Disabled” (Windows) or the egrep check returns 0 (Linux), it usually needs to be turned on in BIOS/UEFI — restart, press F2/F10/Del during boot, enable “Virtualization Technology” / “Intel VT-x” / “AMD-V”. If any other check fails and you're not sure what to do, bring this sheet to Day 00 or Day 1 and ask an instructor before you try to fix it yourself.

Document control. Quick-reference companion to the CodeOps Laptop Readiness Guide. Prepared for IBT College Canada's Full Stack Software Development Program.